

Chapter 96-2

Xu Qingzhu asked from the side, "So what are you planning to make for dinner?"

Liang Shi said, "Rice and stir-fried dishes, plus a soup."

"That's too much trouble." Xu Qingzhu looked at what she had bought. "How about we make dumplings?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Making dumplings seemed like even more trouble, actually.

But since Xu Qingzhu had suggested it, and Liang Shi knew how to make them, she could naturally oblige. When Xu Qingzhu proposed that she would knead the dough while Su Yao would be in charge of washing the vegetables, Liang Shi suddenly understood why Xu Qingzhu had suggested making dumplings.

Everyone would have something to do, so Su Yao wouldn't be left standing idle in the kitchen.

Liang Shi knew how to prepare dumpling filling, and she knew many different kinds.

Since Xu Qingzhu had mentioned it late, she prepared one vegetarian filling and one meat filling.

Mincing meat was a skilled task. Liang Shi's wrists were getting a bit sore from all the chopping. The "thud thud thud thud" sounds echoed in the kitchen, attracting the attention of the children watching TV in the living room. Sheng Yu ran over and hung on the door. "What are you doing?"

"Mincing meat." Liang Shi answered.

"What are we eating tonight?" Sheng Yu asked again.

Liang Shi said, "Dumplings."

Sheng Yu let out an "oh" and ran off to the living room to share the intel with Ling Dang and Rainbow.

Liang Shi had assumed that Xu Qingzhu confidently proposed kneading the dough because she knew how to do it.

But when she finished preparing the filling, the dough under Xu Qingzhu's hands had turned into a sticky mess. She was still adding more flour, even though there was already more than enough flour in the bowl.....

Su Yao watched from the side but didn't say anything.

The atmosphere was actually quite nice.

After all, even though Xu Qingzhu's hands were making a complete mess, her face maintained its confidence throughout.

Liang Shi couldn't help but speak up. "Let me do it."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

She didn't try to tough it out either. She shook off the dough from her hands, pushed the bowl over, and went to wash her hands.

The dough in Liang Shi's hands seemed to come alive, blending together following the direction of her hands, gradually forming into a proper dough ball.

Su Yao suddenly said, "Ah Shi, your cooking skills are quite good."

"It's alright." Liang Shi said. "At least I won't starve to death."

Su Yao smiled gently and praised, "Then our Zhuzi is lucky."

"What do you mean." Xu Qingzhu said quietly. "She's the lucky one."

Liang Shi chimed in, "Yes, marrying Zhuzi is my good fortune."

Xu Qingzhu froze and looked at Liang Shi, only to see Liang Shi with her head down, focused on kneading the dough. What she had just said seemed like it might have been her imagination.

But she had clearly said it.

Her hair was tied loosely, and by now several strands had come loose, hanging down and almost falling into the dough bowl.

Xu Qingzhu immediately brushed them back up for her. Standing behind her, she slid the hair tie off, then retied it a bit tighter. When she did the final tug, she pulled a bit too hard and it stung Liang Shi. "Teacher Xu, you pulled out my hair."

Xu Qingzhu looked sheepish and held out her hand in front of Liang Shi—there was indeed a strand of hair in her palm. "Sorry."

Liang Shi: "....."

Afraid it would fall into the food, Xu Qingzhu quickly threw the hair into the trash.

But Liang Shi said, "I've tied your hair so many times and never pulled any out. Are you trying to make me go bald?"

Xu Qingzhu cleared her throat lightly, feeling a bit guilty. "Sorry."

Standing in the kitchen, Su Yao felt like there was a barrier between herself and the two of them—she simply couldn't fit in.

The two had many small interactions, all formed through their daily accumulation of understanding. They could understand what the other wanted with just a glance.

Back when Su Yao and Sheng Qinglin were dating, it was only after living together for two years that they had developed this kind of tacit understanding.

She and Sheng Qinglin were already considered a match made in heaven in others' eyes.

Because she had experienced such love herself, she could tell at a glance whether it was an act or real.

Just by looking at how those two gazed at each other, Su Yao could tell—this was definitely not an act.

Although she had been fed a mouthful of dog food¹ and couldn't fit into their world, Su Yao was still happy watching them.

Being able to see her daughter happy and content was more important and fulfilling than anything else.

Back then, she had heard from Su Zhe that the person Zhuzi married wasn't good—that there were problems with her character. As for the specifics, Su Zhe didn't tell her much, only told her not to worry and that he would keep an eye on things.

But how could a mother not worry?

Although she had met Liang Shi before and had seen how the two of them interacted, feeling that Liang Shi seemed like a pretty good person who was genuinely good to Zhuzi, she was still afraid it might all be an act.

Su Yao had worried about this for a long time, but now all her worries had vanished like smoke.

Actions can deceive, but eyes cannot.

Liang Shi's sleeve was about to fall down. Xu Qingzhu rolled it up for her, and then noticed a bite mark on her arm. She asked who had bitten her.

Footnotes:

¹ **Dog food (狗粮):** Chinese internet slang referring to public displays of affection between couples. When someone witnesses a couple being lovey-dovey, they say they've been "fed dog food," similar to the English expression of being a "third wheel" but specifically referring to witnessing PDA.